

pseudonym should occur ‘only in the rarest of circumstances.’ [Citation.]” (*Department of Fair Employment and Housing v. Superior Court of Santa Clara County* (2022) 82 Cal.App.5th 105, 111-112.)

As Plaintiff’s identity is known to Defendants, proceeding anonymously would not intrude on their rights. (*Department of Fair Employment and Housing v. Superior Court of Santa Clara County* (2022) 82 Cal.App.5th 105, 110.) Therefore, the only factor the court must consider is whether Plaintiff’s anonymity outweighs the public’s First Amendment interests in knowing the party’s identity.

In ruling on a motion for anonymity, the court must consider all relevant evidence likely to affect the answer, but the moving party seeking anonymity has the burden. (*Department of Fair Employment and Housing v. Superior Court of Santa Clara County* (2022) 82 Cal.App.5th 105, 112.)

Plaintiff’s position that disclosure of the type of medical procedure she was undergoing at that time of the assault does not support the request. Plaintiff’s claim that the possibility of her name would appear in unspecified background checks as an alleged victim of sexual assault is speculative at best. The court also must consider Plaintiff’s need to remain anonymous to avoid being publicly blamed, doubted or judged and traumatized and whether that outweighs the public’s First Amendment right to access to the proceedings, including knowing Plaintiff’s identity. While the Legislature could have identified the ability to use pseudonym’s in every case involving an alleged sexual assault, they chose not to do so. Granting the use of a pseudonym without a specific statute should only be granted in the rarest of circumstances. Plaintiff has failed to meet her burden to show that this is a rare circumstance that overrides the public’s First Amendment rights.

Case Management Conference continued to September 21, 2026, as case not at issue.

5.

CASE #	CASE NAME	HEARING NAME
CVPS2508146	LOPEZ GONZALEZ VS MATARAS	MOTION TO BE RELIEVED AS COUNSEL FOR

Tentative Ruling: No tentative ruling. Hearing taken off calendar as motion was granted.